Summary Statistics and Descriptive Plots

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Data overview

The combined weekly panel contains **765 rows** (participant × week combinations) for **14 participants**. The observation period runs from **25 november 2024** to **23 maart 2026**.

Table 1: Number of observation weeks per participant

Participant	Number of weeks
p01	65
p02	66
p03	66
p04	46
p05	57
p06	66
p07	65
p08	11
p09	65
p10	4
p11	58
p13	64
p14	66
p15	66

Summary statistics

The four research variables summarized across all participants and weeks.

Table 2: Descriptive statistics per research variable

Variable	N	Mean	SD	Min	Max	N missing
Discovery Ratio	765	0.452	0.179	0	1.000	0
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	765	21.279	11.949	0	93.077	0
Like-Rate	765	0.029	0.066	0	1.336	0
Search Intensity	765	20.267	26.646	0	172.000	0

Descriptive plots

Timeline per participant

Each line represents one participant. The timeline shows how the variables develop over the observation period. Notable trends and outliers are immediately visible.

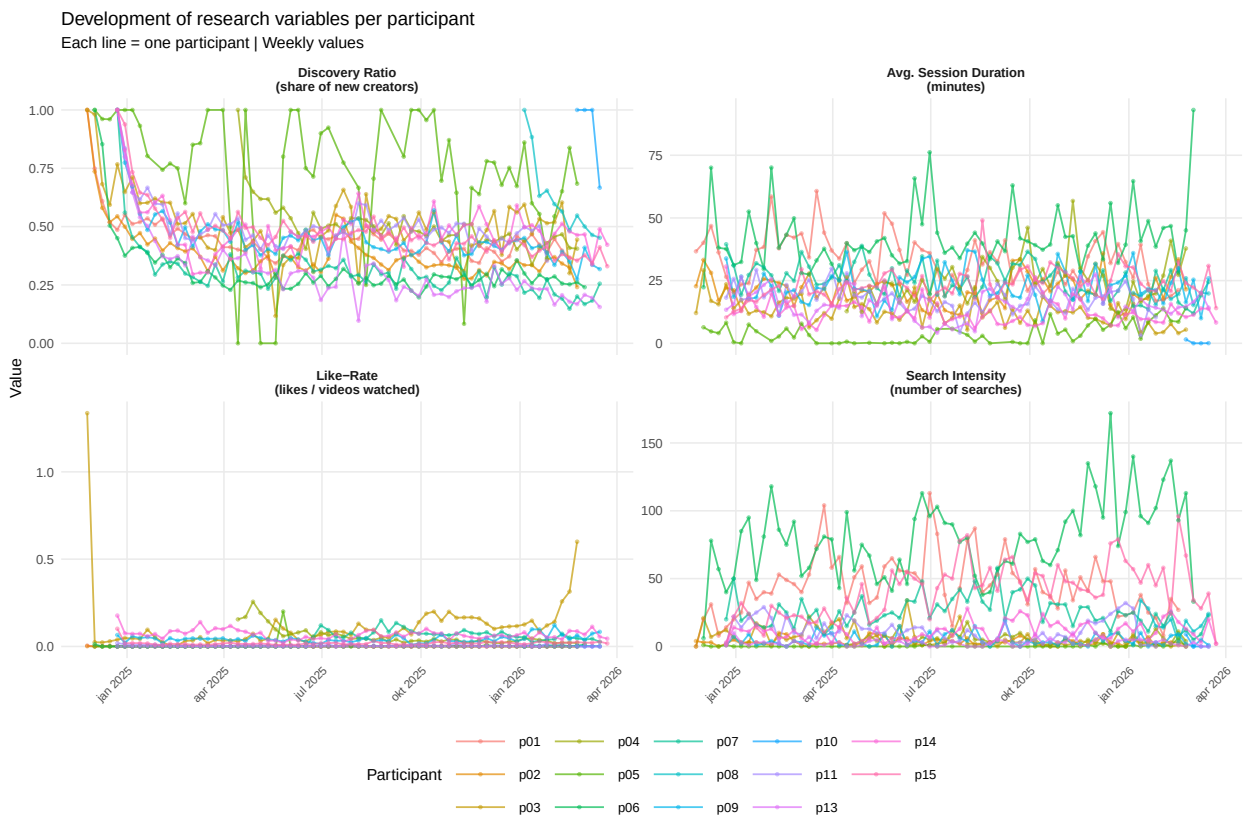

Figure 1: Development of research variables per participant over time

Distribution per variable

Boxplots provide an overview of the distribution of each variable across all participants and weeks. Points outside the whiskers (1.5 × IQR) are considered outliers. Individual data points are shown semi-transparently to convey the density of the data.

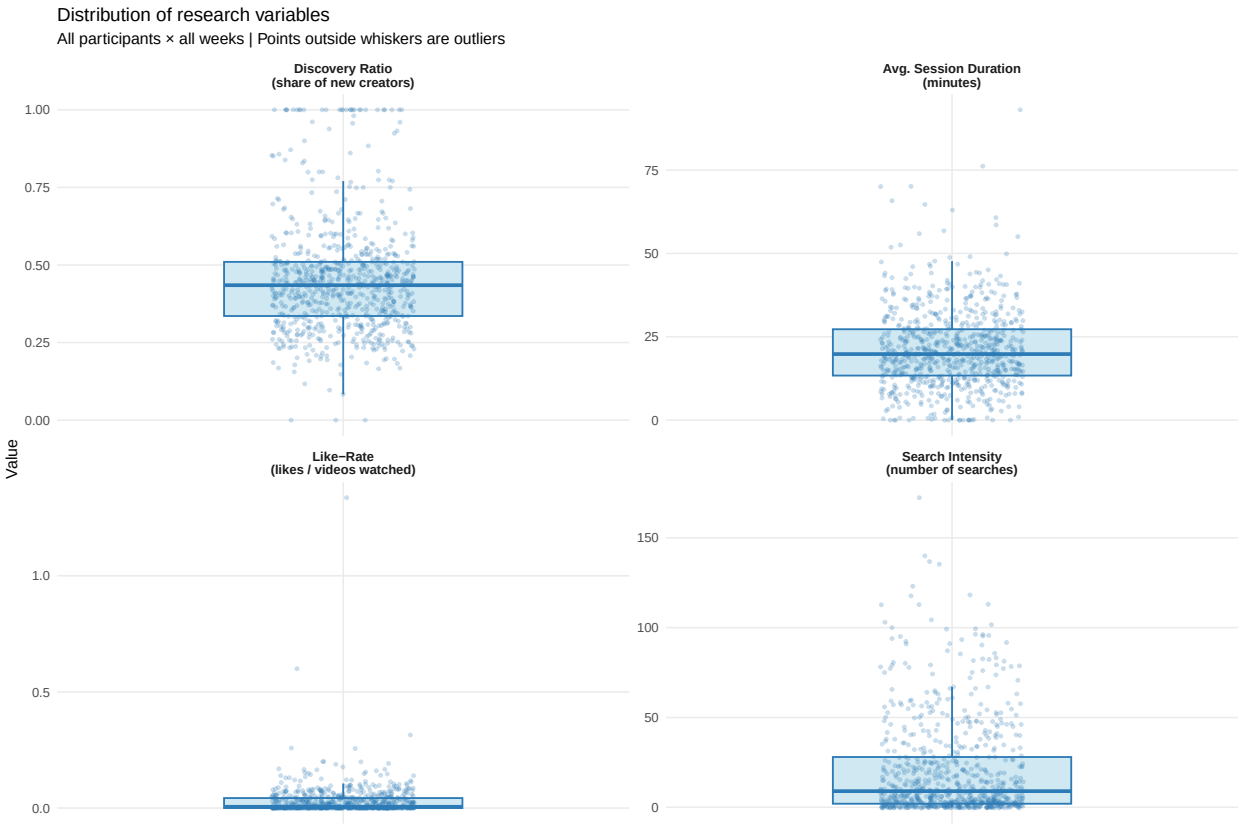

Figure 2: Distribution of research variables (all participants × all weeks)

Outlier analysis

Participant-week combinations above the 99th percentile per variable. These are values that warrant closer inspection to determine whether they are substantively correct or indicative of data issues.

Table 3: Outliers above the 99th percentile per variable

Variable	Participant	Week	Value	P99 threshold
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2026-03-02	93.077	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2025-06-30	76.182	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2025-02-03	70.102	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2024-12-09	70.055	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2025-06-16	65.807	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2026-01-05	64.693	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p06	2025-09-15	63.002	59.329
Avg. Session Duration (min.)	p01	2025-03-17	60.738	59.329
Like-Rate	p03	2024-11-25	1.336	0.194
Like-Rate	p03	2026-02-23	0.600	0.194
Like-Rate	p03	2026-02-16	0.315	0.194
Like-Rate	p03	2026-02-09	0.258	0.194
Like-Rate	p04	2025-04-28	0.256	0.194
Like-Rate	p03	2025-10-13	0.200	0.194
Like-Rate	p05	2025-05-26	0.200	0.194
Like-Rate	p03	2025-10-27	0.199	0.194
Search Intensity	p06	2025-12-15	172.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2026-01-05	140.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2026-02-09	137.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2025-11-24	135.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2026-02-02	123.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2025-02-03	118.000	113.000
Search Intensity	p06	2025-12-01	118.000	113.000

Notes per variable

Avg. Session Duration — Values up to ~93 minutes (p06) are substantively plausible. Long sessions occur when a participant uses TikTok for an extended period. There is no reason to remove these values.

Like-Rate — Values above 1.0 are mathematically impossible given the definition (likes / videos watched), but can arise due to a timing asynchrony: a video is watched in week A but only liked in week B (e.g. via a creator's profile page). Values are capped at 1.0.

Search Intensity — p06 shows consistently high search intensity (up to 172 per week), with an increasing trend towards the end of the observation period. This is substantively plausible (active search behavior) but deviates strongly from the other participants. When modeling, it may be worth considering a log-transformation of this variable due to its strong right skew.